

P. V. RAMKUMAR

Sr. General Manager | Procurement & Supply Chain

26+ Years | Cables | Polymers | Defence | Power Systems | AI-Powered Procurement

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■ EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Seasoned Procurement & Supply Chain Leader with 26+ years of demonstrated excellence across high-complexity, high-volume manufacturing environments — spanning Cables, Polymers, Alloy Wires, Power Systems, Defence, Lithium-Ion Batteries, and Spun Concrete. Has personally stewarded procurement of critical raw materials at industrial scale: Lead (~1,000 MT/month), Nickel & Nickel products (~25 MT/month), Cadmium (~20 MT/month), Tin, Antimony & Bismuth (~20 MT/month), Steel (~600 MT/month), bulk construction materials, and specialist defence-grade components. Equally adept at CAPEX, Greenfield Projects, and Maintenance procurement — with a track record of delivering Rs.325+ Cr in project procurement across multiple greenfield sites.

Currently leading an 11-member procurement team at Thermopads Pvt. Ltd. & Thermo Cables — covering RM, Projects (including Rs.100 Cr TCL plant expansion and Rs.20 Cr Saudi Arabia greenfield plant), CAPEX, and Maintenance. A recognised AI-in-Procurement innovator: built a Reverse Auction Platform that compressed freight forwarder finalization from 2 weeks to 30 minutes (20-25% average savings, 10 FFs, fully transparent process); deployed a Pre-PO Audit Bot achieving 60% error reduction; and automated negotiation workflows via AI bots. Champions rigorous pre-negotiation cost analysis and continuous team learning through weekly Saturday knowledge-sharing sessions.

■ CORE COMPETENCIES

>> High-Volume RM Procurement (Metals, Chemicals, Polymers)	>> Strategic Sourcing & Vendor Development	>> CAPEX & Greenfield Project Procurement	>> AI-Driven Procurement Automation & App Building
>> Defence & Specialised Component Procurement	>> Import & Customs Compliance (Customs Act / DGFT / BIS / GST)	>> Reverse Auction & e-Sourcing Platforms	>> Pre-PO Audit & Document Intelligence
>> Cost Analysis & Pre-Negotiation Frameworks	>> Contract & SLA Management	>> Inventory Management, VED Analysis & JIT	>> Team Building & Knowledge Management
>> Category & Spend Analytics	>> RM for Cables, Batteries & Concrete Structures	>> Regulatory Compliance (GeM / EPCG / BIS / DGFT)	>> Global Sourcing — Europe, China, USA, Middle East

■ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Thermopads Pvt. Ltd. & Thermo Cables | Hyderabad

August 2021 - Present

Sr. General Manager - Procurement

Deliberately joined a high-growth cable & wire manufacturer to build procurement systems from ground up — combining enterprise-grade rigor with the agility of a scaling organisation. Currently leading an 11-member team across four procurement verticals for both entities.

- **Scope:** Complete procurement ownership — Raw Materials (domestic & imports), Projects, CAPEX, and Maintenance for both Thermopads Pvt. Ltd. and Thermo Cables.

- **RM Procurement:** Polymers (PVC, XLPE, ZHFR, PTFE, Silicon Rubber), copper/aluminium conductors, alloy wires, and cable manufacturing machines — sourced domestically and via international imports. Price trend tracking and cost benchmarking for all key categories.
- **TCL Plant Expansion - Rs.100 Cr (Ongoing):** Spearheading end-to-end procurement for Thermo Cables' major plant expansion — covering machinery, civil, electrical, and infrastructure. Managing vendor selection, price negotiation, import clearances, and delivery scheduling.
- **Saudi Arabia Greenfield - Rs.20 Cr (Ongoing):** Leading international machinery procurement for Thermo Cables' new manufacturing facility in Saudi Arabia — managing global vendor identification, techno-commercial evaluation, export/import logistics, and customs compliance.
- **Maintenance & MRO:** Optimized MRO procurement with VED-based spares categorization ensuring uninterrupted production across both plants.
- **AI Reverse Auction - Freight Forwarders:** Designed and deployed reverse auction platform for freight forwarder finalization. Outcome: finalization time reduced from 2 weeks to 30 minutes; 10 FFs competing on equal footing; 20-25% average cost savings; transparent, fair, and competitive process appreciated by all participating FFs.
- **Pre-PO Document Audit Bot:** Built AI-powered system to auto-review purchase documents for compliance gaps, price deviations, approval matrix violations, and data errors before PO issuance. Result: 60% reduction in document errors, significantly cutting audit findings and rework.
- **Auto-Negotiation Bot:** Deployed AI bot to autonomously handle initial supplier negotiation rounds, allowing the team to focus on strategic and high-value procurement decisions.
- **Price Analytics Dashboards:** Developed automated price trend trackers for PVC, XLPE, ZHFR, PTFE, and Silicon Rubber — enabling data-driven category management and negotiation benchmarks.
- **Pre-Negotiation Cost Analysis:** Conducts detailed cost breakup study — raw material component analysis, process cost, overhead mapping, and market benchmarking — as a standard discipline before every negotiation, ensuring confident and defensible price positions.
- **Team Building & Learning Culture:** Runs weekly Saturday knowledge-sharing sessions with the 11-member team covering procurement best practices, AI tools, market trends, and case-study-based learning — building a high-competence, continuously improving team.
- **Compliance:** Full adherence to Customs Act 1962, DGFT, BIS, GST, and GeM regulations across all procurement activities.
- **Vendor Management:** Rationalised AVL; built strategic supplier partnerships for critical RM and CAPEX categories.

HBL Power Systems Ltd. | Hyderabad (Multi-location)

2001 - July 2021 (20 Years)

Asst. General Manager - Corporate Purchase Head

Led a 35-member central and plant-level procurement team across multiple locations for a listed, diversified manufacturing conglomerate — spanning specialized batteries (Lead Acid, Ni-Cd, Lithium-Ion), Defence Electronics, Railway Signalling, Solar, and Spun Concrete Structures. Managed procurement of some of the highest-volume industrial raw materials in the segment.

High-Volume Raw Material Procurement

- **Lead (~1,000 MT/month):** Primary RM for lead acid batteries. Managed domestic and import sourcing — price fixation on LME-linked contracts, quality controls (purity grades), multi-supplier strategy for continuity and competitive pricing.
- **Nickel & Nickel Products (~25 MT/month):** Critical input for Ni-Cd and alkaline batteries. Sourced Nickel Anode, Nickel Hydroxide, and Nickel salts domestically and via imports; achieved significant savings through import substitution with domestic suppliers.
- **Cadmium (~20 MT/month):** Specialty metal for Ni-Cd battery cathodes. Managed sourcing from qualified domestic and international suppliers with strict regulatory and safety compliance.
- **Tin, Antimony & Bismuth (~20 MT/month):** Procured for alloy formulation in battery grids; managed commodity price risk through forward pricing and multi-source strategies.
- **Steel (~600 MT/month):** Structural steel, HR/CR coils, and rebar for battery containers, concrete divisions, and fabrication requirements. Bulk contracting with steel mills; achieved significant savings through spot buying at market troughs.
- **Battery Chemicals (Large Volumes):** Procurement of sulphuric acid, potassium hydroxide (KOH), various electroplating chemicals, process chemicals, and lab reagents — domestic and imports — ensuring quality compliance and supply continuity.
- **Brass Components (Costing-Based Price Fixation):** Managed complex brass component procurement with price fixation based on detailed cost analysis — LME copper/zinc components, process cost, and conversion charges. Eliminated supplier price escalation through transparent costing model.

- **MS Components & Steel Fabrication:** Sourced machined and sheet metal fabricated components; managed vendor development, drawing-based sourcing, and quality approval processes.
- **Injection-Moulded Plastics:** PPCP, Nylon, PET, HDPE components for battery casings, separators, and fittings — domestically sourced with approved vendor development.
- **Rubber & Sealing Components:** Battery seals, gaskets, and specialty rubber parts — sourced with stringent quality requirements.
- **Packing Materials:** High-volume procurement of packaging materials; introduced alternate packing system in collaboration with Quality and Design teams — achieving significant cost reduction and standardization.

Defence Battery Procurement

- **Defence-Grade RM & Components:** Procured specialised, high-specification raw materials and components for defence batteries — silver oxide, specialty separators, military-grade casings, and other restricted-use materials — both domestically and via controlled imports.
- **Regulatory & Quality Compliance:** Ensured full compliance with DRDO/DPSUs quality standards, import licensing, and end-use certificate requirements for defence-related procurement.
- **Vendor Qualification:** Managed complex defence vendor qualification processes; developed and maintained approved vendor base for high-criticality items with zero compromise on specifications.

Spun Concrete Division — Civil & Structural RM

- **Bulk Cement:** Large-volume cement sourcing for spun pole and pile manufacturing plants at Hyderabad, Vizianagaram, and Guntur — long-term rate contracts with cement majors ensuring price stability and supply reliability.
- **Concrete & Aggregates:** Sand, aggregates, admixtures — locally sourced at each plant location with competitive rate finalizations.
- **PC Wire & Structural Steel:** Pre-stressed concrete wire, rebar, and structural steel — bulk contracting ensuring quality (IS standards) and cost competitiveness.
- **Civil Construction Materials:** Complete civil RM procurement for all greenfield plant constructions — TMT bars, cement, hardware, and finishing materials.

Solar, Lithium-Ion & Capital Equipment

- **Lithium-Ion Battery RM:** Procurement of lithium cells, electrolytes, cathode materials, BMS components, and pack assembly materials — largely sourced through international suppliers from Japan, South Korea, and China.
- **Solar Components:** Procurement of solar panels, inverters, mounting structures, cables, and BoS components — domestic and overseas — for HBL's solar division.
- **Capital Equipment (All Divisions):** End-to-end CAPEX procurement for battery manufacturing lines, concrete production machines, solar test equipment, and defence electronics assembly — including global sourcing, techno-commercial evaluations, and import management.

Greenfield Projects & Landmark Achievements

- **Lead Acid Battery Plant, Vizianagaram — Rs.175 Cr (2005-07):** Steered complete project procurement from civil to equipment commissioning — on time, within budget.
- **Spun Concrete Plants — Rs.150 Cr (2010-15):** Managed procurement for 3 greenfield plants at Hyderabad, Vizianagaram & Guntur simultaneously.
- **Lithium-Ion Battery Plants, Hyderabad (2019-21):** Led CAPEX and project procurement for two Li-Ion manufacturing plant setups.
- **Import Substitution:** Drove domestic development of A-class imported materials (Steel, Nickel Anode, KOH) — reducing costs, shortening lead times, and improving inventory control.
- **5S in Procurement:** Implemented 5S methodology — created lean, segmented, and motivated vendor base with measurable process improvements.
- **VED Analysis for MRO:** Implemented Vital-Essential-Desirable spares classification enabling VMI, JIT decisions, and significant inventory reduction.
- **SAP MM:** Core team member for group-wide SAP implementation; developed procurement SOPs and benchmarks across all divisions.
- **Quality Compliance:** ISO, IRIS (Railway), EASA/Aviation (domestic & European), OSHAS, EMS standards.

■ KEY ACHIEVEMENTS AT A GLANCE

- **Rs.325+ Cr in Greenfield Project Procurement:** 3 major projects delivered — Lead Acid plant (Rs.175 Cr), Spun Concrete multi-site (Rs.150 Cr), and Li-Ion plants at HBL.
- **TCL Plant Expansion Rs.100 Cr + Saudi Greenfield Rs.20 Cr (Ongoing):** Simultaneously managing two live capital projects across domestic and international geographies.
- **Reverse Auction — Freight Forwarder Finalization:** 2 weeks to 30 minutes; 10 FFs; 20-25% average savings; transparent & fair process — now a best-practice standard.
- **Pre-PO Audit Bot:** 60% reduction in procurement document errors — significantly reducing audit findings and rework cost.
- **High-Volume Commodity Management:** Sustained procurement of Lead (1,000 MT/mo), Steel (600 MT/mo), Nickel (25 MT/mo), Cadmium (20 MT/mo), Tin/Antimony/Bismuth across multi-year cycles without supply disruption.
- **Brass Component Cost Model:** Eliminated price escalation disputes through transparent LME-based costing framework — adopted as group standard.
- **Import Substitution:** Developed domestic alternatives for A-class imports, reducing costs and improving supply resilience.
- **Defence Procurement Expertise:** Successfully managed procurement of restricted, high-specification defence battery materials — domestic and imports — with full regulatory compliance.
- **Cost Analysis Discipline:** Institutionalized detailed pre-negotiation cost study as standard — ensuring fact-based, defensible pricing across all categories.
- **Team & Knowledge Building:** Weekly Saturday learning sessions driving continuous upskilling of the 11-member team in procurement, AI, and market dynamics.

■ INDUSTRY & DOMAIN EXPERTISE

Cables & Polymers	Power, Defence & Batteries	AI-Powered Procurement
◦ PVC, XLPE, ZHFR, PTFE, Silicon Rubber ◦ Copper & aluminium conductors ◦ Alloy wires ◦ Cable manufacturing machinery ◦ RM for cables — domestic & imports	◦ Lead Acid, Ni-Cd, Lithium-Ion batteries ◦ Defence-grade RM & specialty components ◦ Solar components & systems ◦ Railway signalling electronics ◦ Spun concrete structures (poles, piles)	◦ Reverse auction platform (built in-house) ◦ Auto-negotiation bots ◦ Pre-PO AI document audit system ◦ Price trend analytics dashboards ◦ Workflow automation for transactions

■ EDUCATION & PERSONAL DETAILS

Education

B.E. (Mechanical Engineering)

North Maharashtra University | 1999

Personal Details

Date of Birth: 22nd November 1975

Languages: English, Hindi, Telugu

Location: Alwal, Secunderabad - 500010

■ TRAININGS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Management Accounting — Working Capital, Inventory & Budget Management, Strategic Value Programs

- Quality Management Systems — ISO, IRIS (Railway International Standards), EASA Aviation (Domestic & European), OSHAS, EMS
- Leadership, Team Building & Communication Skills
- SAP MM — Core implementation team member for group-wide rollout
- AI & Procurement Automation — Prompt Engineering, Agentic AI, Python scripting for procurement workflows (self-directed)

References & detailed project documentation available upon request